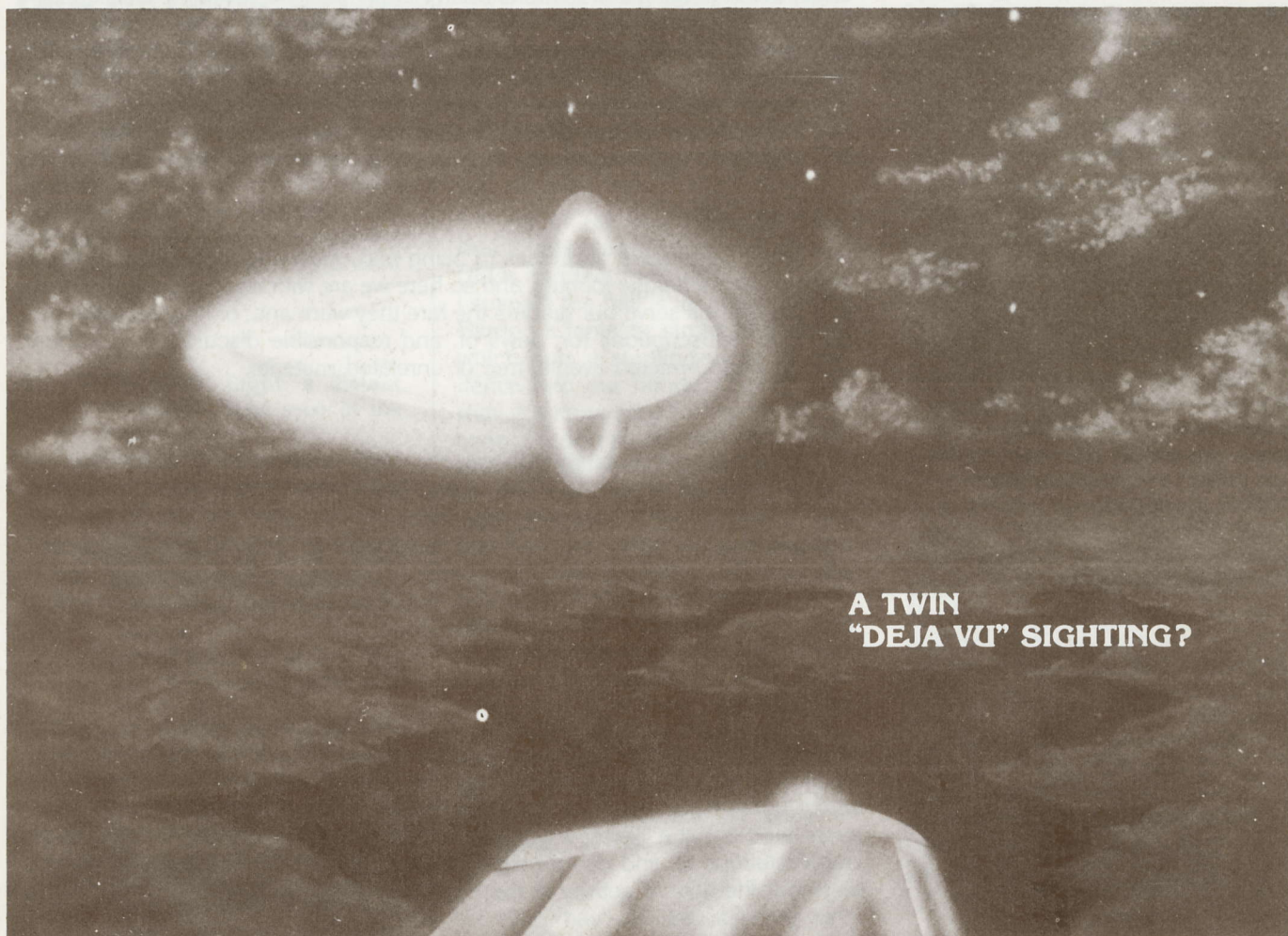


INTERNATIONAL

JANUARY 1982
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UFO

REPORTER



Painting by Witness

An ASSOCIATE Publication of the CENTER FOR UFO STUDIES

EDITORIAL



Photography by Lauren Shay

The INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER is published bi-monthly by the Center for UFO Studies, Evanston, Illinois, and is mailed as Third Class Mail at Lima, Ohio to financial contributors to the Center for UFO Studies according to the schedule of ASSOCIATES. Copyright 1982 by the Center for UFO Studies, all rights reserved. No part of this issue may be reproduced by any mechanical, photographic or electronic process or otherwise copied for public or private use without written permission from the publisher. Allow six weeks for change of address. Please send old and new address with notification to:

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER
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John P. Timmerman
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Once again a transition! This one, we sincerely hope, will be the last, at least for quite some time. We have now arrived, we believe, at a measure of permanence in publication policy and format as well. It is an ill-wind indeed that blows no good whatever; the present harsh economic winds have blown some good in forcing us to adopt a firm editorial policy and a stream-lined format which will best serve the purposes of the Center for UFO Studies and the needs and wishes of our Associates.

Under the new system, the International UFO Reporter (IUR) will continue to be published bi-monthly and will alternate each month with the Associates Newsletter. And, barring truly emergency situations, each of these publications will be out on time. It is not pleasant for IUR readers to get the May-June issue in September!

We are grateful to the many supporters, the great majority in fact, who have patiently borne with us through past difficulties. Largely financial and logistical, which dictated our various past moves...from the first years of IUR under the managing editorship of Allan Hendry, who achieved an excellence in factual presentation and in art work it would be difficult to exceed, through the unfortunate and abortive attempt at cooperation with the ill-fated PROBE magazine (which folded after a few issues) and on to a renewed effort at cooperation with another independent publication as a vehicle, this time, SECOND LOOK which almost immediately decided to change its name to FRONTIERS OF SCIENCE, and now, finally, to being once again entirely on our own.

There were grave difficulties in being part of another publication and yet retaining one's unique identity, and so here we are with an approach which we truly believe will serve our readers the fare they want and, of course, what they paid their subscriptions for: news of, and responsible discussion of, current UFO and UFO-related events, free of unrelated material.

With this issue I assume full editorial responsibility for IUR, which may not always totally reflect the opinions of the Center staff as to content, inferences and conclusions expressed by the editor. To alleviate this and to broaden outlook, short articles from staff and Associates are invited, and if accepted, will carry the by-line of the author. Letters from readers of relevant interest to other readers are especially welcome; this should be your magazine as well as that of the Center.

Our aim will continue to be to present direct, honest and responsible reporting of the current UFO scene, as we see it here at the Center. Along with its bimonthly companion publication, the ASSOCIATES NEWSLETTER, for which John Timmerman is editorially responsible, we feel that you who are associated with the Center will be even better informed than ever about current manifestations of, and current thought about, the UFO phenomenon, as well as about the flow of activity at the Center for UFO Studies.

A handwritten signature in dark ink, reading "J. Allen Hynek". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "J." and last name "Hynek" clearly legible.

How We Learn Of UFO Sightings

UFO sighting reports reach us from news departments, civilian organizations and individuals all over the world, but most of our reports are received via the Center for UFO Studies' UFO Hotline. This 24-hour, toll-free telephone service is for the exclusive use of U.S. law enforcement agencies, FAA facilities, planetaria and other formal channels. It permits the rapid follow-up of important cases for first-hand information from the reporting witnesses. It also permits: pre-screening of most hoaxes, rapid deployment of on-site investigators and the encouragement of local official assistance.

How We Define UFOS:

A UFO is any anomalous aerial phenomena whose appearances and/or behaviours cannot be ascribed to conventional natural or man-made causes either by the original witnesses or by other technically trained analysts after thorough investigation using the best techniques and equipment currently available.

- NL — Nocturnal Light: a distant anomalous light seen in the night sky.
- DD — Daylight Disc: a distant object seen under daylight conditions, often disc-shaped.
- RV — Radar/Visual: UFOs detected visually and by Radar simultaneously. Good agreement between the two accounts is essential.
- CE I — Close Encounter of the First Kind: a UFO seen within 500 feet.
- CE II — Close Encounter of the Second Kind: a CE I which includes a verifiable change in the environment such as physical traces, physiological effects and electromagnetic interferences.
- CE III — Close Encounter of the Third Kind: a CE I or II including the report of associated creatures, humanoids or robots.

LETTERS

Dear Dr. Hynek,

I would like to share a thought which represents my feelings about ufology and UFO investigation. All of us, high and low, are very much the prisoners of our own ignorance about the universe in which we live. We tread on very shallow ground when we attempt to consider all UFO phenomena in terms of our own scientific and personal perceptions about that universe and our Earth. Therefore, all evidence gathered in our investigations of UFO sighting reports, no matter how seemingly tedious or fanciful, may have more significance than we know. Perhaps future generations may very well consider our UFO experiences in terms as mundane in their times as powered flight has become in ours. But, I am merely reciting the obvious to you and to everyone else seriously concerned with ufology.

All of us would like to have many questions answered about UFOs and that may yet happen, but I suspect the ball is in "their" court. Barring a fantastic stroke of fortune which puts a startling piece of evidence into our hands, (though we may not know how to interpret it or even recognize it, initially), we'll undoubtedly learn about "them at their" discretion, however that manipulation occurs.

If, in fact, the phenomenon called "UFOs" eventually is revealed to be a misunderstood part of our natural environment (which I seriously doubt), it may only be fully understood when a new and revolutionary view of natural science seriously modifies or demolishes our present concept of what is "absolute" in that regard.

We may well be standing on the threshold of a new scientific age as revolutionary to our times as the

discoveries of Newton, Galileo and Copernicus were to their times . . . and just as unsettling.

Richard A. Busse
Rensselaer, Indiana
November 17, 1981

(Similar thoughts have been received over the years at CUFOS, but rarely expressed so well as in the above letter. Ed.)

Dear Dr. Hynek,

Would you be kind enough to announce that all medical doctors and psychologists interested in assisting UFOMD in our recently established medical network should contact me at the following address. We need help for future cases during this two-year study (of reported medical injuries associated with alleged UFO Close Encounters).

Richard C. Niemtzow, M.D.
166 Cannon Drive
Travis AFB, CA 94535

(Readers may refer to CUFOS ASSOCIATE NEWSLETTER, November 1981, page 4, for details.)

Dear Gentlemen,

I attend the secondary school in Warsaw and live in this city. From the eighth form of elementary school I have begun to be interested in UFO, hearing many interesting and mysterious tidings from the press newsclippings and reports.

I am afraid I will accept only really serious news about UFO. Please help me be informed on the worldwide UFO activity. I am looking forward to your exhaustive information.

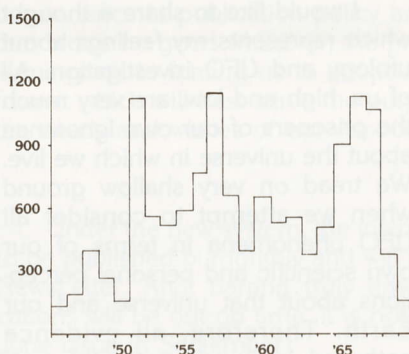
Krzysztof Piechucki
Warsaw, Poland
October 5, 1981 □

UFO INDEX "The Dow-Jones of UFOlogy"

As 1981 closed there was a slight upswing in the flow of UFO reports, but more importantly it saw a 'better class' of UFO reports being received at CUFOS. Most of these continued to be 'oldies but goodies' in that the witnesses had for some reason been reluctant to report, often for years, or perhaps didn't know where to report. Most of these came in through the mail from the witnesses directly or through CUFOS and MUFON investigators, or sometimes by phone.

The police 'hot-line' was disappointingly unproductive of good cases but over-productive of IFOs or 'lights in the night sky' reports which generally turned out to be astronomical in character, especially Venus which attained greatest brilliancy on Dec. 18, mixed in with the usual twinkling stars, notably the star Sirius. Would that the public were better informed in astronomy!

Apropos of the reluctance of witnesses to report, the 'Iron Mountain Experiment' produced some interesting results. It was an attempt to smoke out some hidden cases in that area about which we had heard rumors from time to time. Iron Mountain is a small town in northern Michigan not far from



Air Force Totals by Year

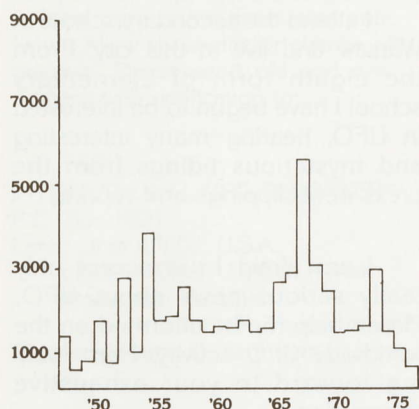
Marquette where Dr. Kenneth Schellhase is professor of history at the University of Northern Michigan. Since I was to be passing through there in late October, I had suggested to Dr. Schellhase, who is also a member of the CUFOS scientific board, that he let it be known in the local paper and radio that I would be available at the local library one evening to hold an informal discussion on UFOs and especially to learn of previously unreported UFO events.

To my surprise and pleasure, some 250 people turned out that evening, some of whom made appointments with me for the following day to discuss their UFO sightings. Of great interest to me was that, to a person, those who had had UFO experiences had not reported their sighting to the police or in any other official way. They all stated that they "didn't want people to think I'm crazy." One outstanding example of this was a witness to a UFO event in 1965 but who had since then told only his wife and his doctor about the encounter! It was a CE-II case in which an illuminated disc had paused over his car, bathing him in light; as a result of this, presumably, he suffered considerable physical

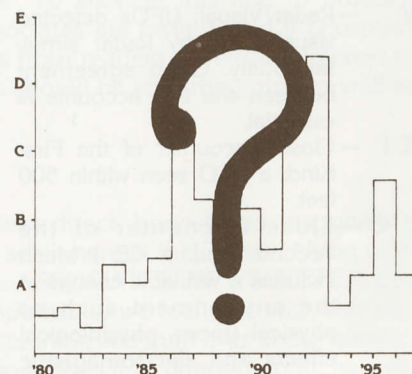
distress. But for sixteen years he had kept quiet about it. This is a marked example of the general observation that it is the 'high strangeness' cases that have the greatest time lag between event and report.

We are now planning a similar experiment in Hibbing, MN and hope to try others across the country as opportunity permits. It seems that people will confide their UFO experiences if they can be completely assured that they will be listened to sympathetically and not become targets for publicity and ridicule.

Well, 1982 is here but there is no basis for predicting the level of UFO activity. It might be noted, however, that 1982 marks the 35th anniversary of the triggering Kenneth Arnold sighting which, while it seems to have started things off, did introduce the ridicule-inviting term, FLYING SAUCER. Also it marks nine years since the last major wave of UFO sightings in the U.S. and since the founding of CUFOS. Now, let's see...if we add 35 and 9, divide it into 1982 and multiply by the square root of...no, numerology will not help in predicting UFO flaps. We'll just have to wait and see. □



UFOCAT Totals by Year



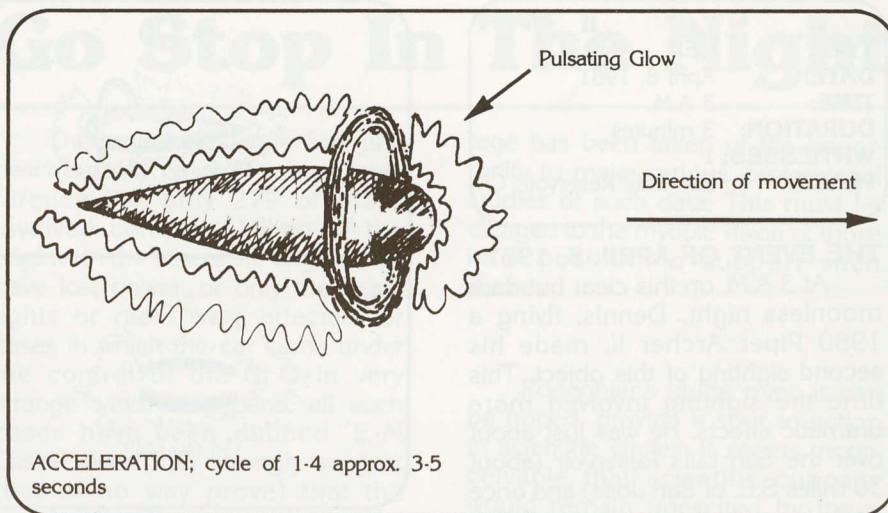
Who Knows?

A Twin "DEJA VU" Sighting?

The following reports would not appear in these pages were it not for the fact that these accounts came to me through a long personal interview with the witness, in the company of Mr. Tom Page, a trusted MUFON investigator who had known the witness, Mr. Dennis, for many years, having actually taught him in a 9th grade science class many years ago. He had also interrogated Mr. Dennis in detail before my interview on other occasions, and, privately, expressed utmost faith in Mr. Dennis' integrity. Furthermore, Mr. Dennis has been a pilot for some ten years, is a licensed flight instructor, and directs a charter plane service in California. He is quite familiar with many sorts of 'sights in the sky' and has a long record of 'common sense stability.' Still, as you will note, these are extraordinary accounts.

Essentially, Mr. Dennis saw, each time from his plane, the identical wingless, bullet-shaped craft; the first time from about a quarter-mile distance; the second time he was able to get to about 500 feet behind it and get a better view. He estimated its size at 10 to 15 meters (33 to 50 feet) in length and about 5 meters (16 feet) in diameter. During this second time he experienced a complete communications blackout. Although the objects were reported as being identical, the first is classified as a nocturnal light because of its distance, but the second as a Close Encounter of the Second Kind because of its closeness and the interference with the radio system. It is of interest that both occurred in the immediate vicinity of bodies of land-locked water in very isolated regions.

TYPE:	NL
DATE:	Nov. 5, 1980
TIME:	8:45 P.M.
DURATION:	30-45 seconds
WITNESSES:	1; probably 3
PLACE:	Lake Berryessa, CA



THE EVENT OF NOVEMBER 5, 1980

Dennis had just dropped off a charter passenger at Chico, CA. and was on his way back to base in Marin County, CA., flying a 1980 Piper Turbo Saratoga SP at 8000 feet. It was about 8:30 P.M. when, in response to his query about a light off his left wing, the Oakland Tower informed him that "we don't show any aircraft." Dennis, however, had spotted an orange bullet-shaped light, of about the same apparent size as the moon, that was keeping even with him, at about 185 knots.

The object had no discernible wings (a fact that was confirmed by his second sighting when he was closer to the object). This statement alone tends to stop one in his tracks and intellectually rebel: there just can't be wingless craft that behave as this did! But here we have an experienced pilot telling us this, a man who runs his own charter plane company, a flight instructor, and who has had ample experience in the air, who started flying gliders at the age of 10 with an instructor (regulations would not allow him to solo until he was 14). He did solo at age 14 and started flying powered planes at 15. If he says that on two occasions he saw a wingless craft fairly close by, I find no compelling reason to disbelieve him.

Very quickly the light brightened and began to pulse with a steadily increasing frequency. The front portion brightened so much

that it took on the appearance of a fireball. "I thought it might be some kind of missile detonating." Just then it shot forward;... "no way to describe how incredible the acceleration was." Then it made a sudden perfect right-angle turn upward. "It wasn't a pull-up type of thing...it was just a perfect 90 degree upturn."

In less than a minute the whole thing was over. He called the Oakland Tower and was told that "they'd been seeing that thing all around the Bay." Dennis remarked, "The controller seemed unusually exited about this thing."

Five minutes later it appeared again. This time behind him, in his 5 o'clock position. Much the same thing happened but this time, after executing another right-angle turn upward, it shot into the overcast which covered a part of the sky, illuminating the base of the overcast as it did so. As he reported this to the Oakland Center... "Wow, it just shot up again"...he was overheard by a commercial airliner at 25,000 feet which reported to the Oakland Center: "Yea, he's not lying...we just saw it come up through the undercast." According to Dennis, this was also observed by the airliner's copilot. Unfortunately, tape records are no longer available.

II

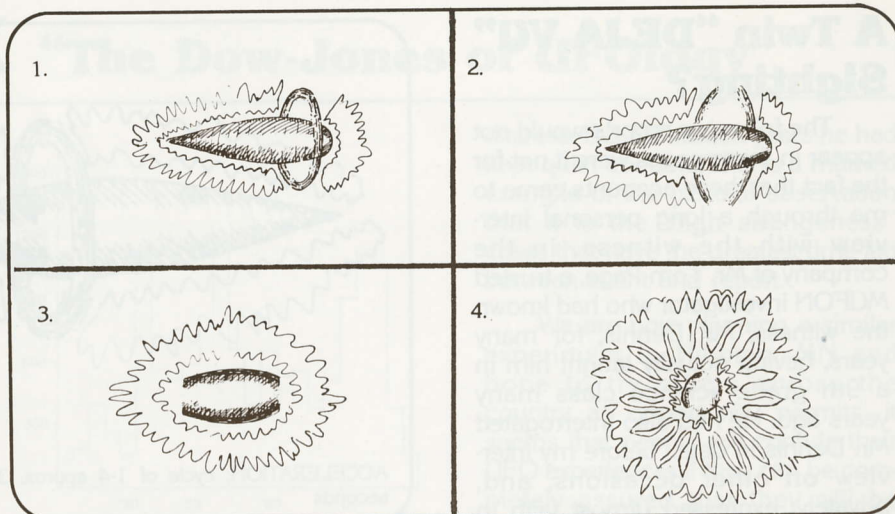
TYPE: CE-II
DATE: April 8, 1981
TIME: 3 A.M.
DURATION: 3 minutes
WITNESSES: 1
PLACE: San Luis Reservoir, CA

THE EVENT OF APRIL 8, 1981

At 3 A.M. on this clear but dark moonless night, Dennis, flying a 1980 Piper Archer II, made his second sighting of this object. This time the sighting involved more dramatic effects. He was just about over the San Luis Reservoir (about 30 miles S.E. of San Jose) and once again in very open country, and also once again flying back from a charter plane trip (to Palm Springs), when the object pulled alongside his 3 o'clock position. As it did so, his DME (distance measuring equipment) went out, then his navigation and communications radios* likewise (with the latter he couldn't even pick up static). When his transponder went out, this caused some concern at the Tower for he had disappeared from their scope.

Now the object shot forward of him some 500 yards, Dennis estimates, and executed some very erratic motions. Then, slowly drifting backwards until it was at his 9 o'clock position, it paced him, "obviously looking me over" said Dennis, maintaining a steady course. Gaining confidence, ("After all," said Dennis, "nothing happened to me the first time") he now deliberately drifted behind and somewhat below it, coming he believes as close as 500 feet to it at one instant. He continued to drop back, placing the object first at his 1-2 o'clock position and then finally at his 11 o'clock position. He had a much better chance to observe it this time; the accompanying drawings reflect the second sighting. The whirling bluish ring, the orange glow and the bullet shape were identical both times, Dennis maintained.

*1st Comm/King Ky 196/197
 1st Nav—King KN 53 Loge Indicator 1000
 2nd Comm/Nav KX 175 B Indicator KI 205 (King)



1. Pulsation increases—ring spools up to incredible speed—object begins to glow brightly.
2. Because of increasing speed, ring begins to vanish—object begins to take on a very bright glow.
3. Pulsation stops and is replaced by a total,

overall increase in light—object shape becoming hard to see because of brightness of light.

4. Object now totally unrecognizable—object takes on a "fireball" type of appearance—light is very bright but does not hurt my eyes to look at—object now accelerates away at tremendous speed.

In my interview with him, he stressed the bluish ring, shown clearly in the drawing. It started close to the body of the craft, whirling at right angles to it, and then, as it whirled faster and faster, it expanded, becoming thinner and finally dissipating.

Now it happened again: the front part of the bullet began to pulsate, faster and faster, and now appeared as a bright solid glow... "Really, really bright" reported Dennis in our interview, "a very intense red orange" and looked like a "contained explosion." It then shot forward to about four or five miles ahead of the plane, about twice as far as the first time, but the acceleration was not as great this time. "It wasn't such a quick jump away." Once again an instantaneous right-angle turn upward and in four or five seconds it was lost in the black sky above.

Now all the radios came back on again, by themselves, and "I could hear the Center frequency talking, and called them up. They had been worried about me...they didn't have a primary target on me."

Illuminated, wingless craft that pace commercial and private planes have been reported from time to time. How many have gone unreported can only be guessed. Airline pilots shy away from making official reports but occasionally the event comes to light, generally in a casual way. In this case, an accidentally overheard conversation led to eventual contact with Tom Page and then through Paul Cerny and Marvin Taylor, both MUFON investigators, to me at the time of a chance visit to San Francisco. It has now also come to the attention of Dr. Richard Haines, whose active interest in pilot and aircraft-involved UFO encounters is well known. He is preparing a compilation of such sightings, the publication of which is eagerly awaited. It will undoubtedly contain other accounts of encounters with wingless craft. For readers interested in an account already published, the 122-page report, "A Helicopter-UFO Encounter Over Ohio" by J. Zeidman is available from the CUFOS Information Services. □

CARS That Go Stop In The Night

"As the two witnesses saw the multi-colored object come to within 100 feet of the car, the car engine failed. The object hovered at 75 feet above the ground for three minutes, then slowly moved away. The car could then be restarted without trouble."

"The motorist saw a 100-150 foot diameter, Saturn-shaped disc with a row of oval windows. He flashed his headlights three times where-upon the object came straight at him and passed only 30 feet overhead. His lights, engine, and radio went out as it did so and he felt increased heat. Then the object sped quickly away and then the car functioned normally."

These are but two of the 279 very similar cases of car engine failure tabulated and studied in a recent publication of the Center for UFO Studies. The author, Mark Rodeghier, is well known to many ufologists and is also one of the directors of the Center. The study, **UFO REPORTS INVOLVING VEHICLE INTERFERENCE, A CATALOGUE AND DATA ANALYSIS**, is certain to become a standard reference work and a landmark in this field. In addition to being a comprehensive (but not exhaustive) compilation of that class of Close Encounters of the Second Kind which interact with environment in a most specific way by interfering with moving vehicles, it presents a meaningful statistical study of correlations between motions, sizes, colors, sounds etc. of the UFO and their reported physical effects on the vehicles.

The actual catalogue lists and describes 441 cases of vehicle interference but only 279 of these involved complete killing of the engine; in the others the engine may have lost power, or only the headlights or radio were affected, or cases in which the car came under the control of the UFO in very strange ways. In general, all such cases have been dubbed 'E-M Cases' since they strongly suggest (but in no way prove) that the reported interference was caused by the presence of a strong electromagnetic field. It is a convenient label, but somewhat confusing; Rodeghier found it expedient to isolate the engine-killing cases, calling them specifically the EM cases, (perhaps EK would have been better?).

VEHICLE INTERFERENCE CASES FORM AN ESPECIALLY INTERESTING SCIENTIFIC PUZZLE,

even more so in some ways than those Close Encounter cases in which tangible physical residues are left (such as scorched vegetation etc.), for here the witness has, in a sense, a recording instrument, the car itself. The witness (actually in one half of these cases there is more than one witness) is in effect making a 'meter reading' when he notes the effects on his instrument, the car. In cases of permanent damage (such as a melted battery) the 'reading' is 'recorded'!

Physical trace cases and radar-visual cases provide us, so far, with the closest thing to 'hard data' and it is unfortunate that so little advan-

tage has been taken of the opportunity to make serious, professional studies of such data. This must be charged to the myopic vision of those in a position to support such studies.

Rodeghier's study may, it can be hoped, provide a spur to action in scientific circles; it seems inconceivable that scientific curiosity would remain unexcited by these data. Anyone with a well-developed scientific curiosity should not only be intrigued but shocked into action by the sort of evidence presented especially by these EM cases.

The full 155 page report is available in limited printing from the Center for UFO Studies (price \$8 plus \$1.50 postage and handling); here only a very brief resume of its scope can be given. The catalogue itself comprises 75 pages and unlike most catalogues, this one is as exciting to read as an adventure story. Each entry is a capsule summary of the reported event, and together they represent a collection of startling adventures experienced by otherwise perfectly normal humans (as Rodeghier's study of the witnesses themselves shows). That these experiences, in three-quarters of the cases, occurred in rural or deserted areas, and often in the wee hours of the morning, just adds to the sense of adventure.

A word about the 'wee hours' occurrence in some cases. The actual graph of times of occurrence shows a peak at about 9-11 P.M. On the assumption that EM events are not 'staged' (that is, that the 'intelligence' behind the event does not choose a given car to disturb and the vehicle just happens to be there at random) then, since there are far more cars on the road between 9

Cars

and 11 P.M. than there are around 3 A.M., it follows that there would be more vehicles around to experience an EM effect if the UFOs were also present at random. Rodeghier adjusts for this distribution by normalizing the data for vehicles on the road (that is by assuming a constant number of vehicles in each hour interval) and finds that the frequency of occurrence of EM cases peaks at 3 A.M.! This supports the results found earlier by Vallee and Poher and others.

But suppose that the events are 'staged.' Then we have a totally different situation. Let us imagine, as an illustration, a schoolboy poking a stick into an ant colony, killing an ant here and there. The ants might imagine that the more ants around, the greater chance of an ant-kill. But the event is 'staged.' The killings occur late in the afternoon because that is the time the boy is passing by on his way home from school, and he deliberately sets out to disturb the ant colony, perhaps even choosing a particular ant to kill. The ants' conclusions based on the idea that the boy is present at all times would of course be incorrect.

There is some intriguing evidence to suggest that UFO events of all kinds (not just EM cases) may be purposeful and deliberate, perhaps to call mankind's attention to something normally beyond his ken. If the UFO 'chooses' a particular car at a particular time to effect it as the little boy chose an ant to kill, then these particular correlations Rodeghier found would not be valid. There are many others, however, which would remain valid.

Rodeghier finds two groups of physical things which seem to have a strong tendency to occur together. The first comprises the chasing of

the vehicle by the UFO, the color blue, physiological effects on the witnesses, presence of a light beam, and control (out-of-control, really) of the car by the UFO; the second, metallic color, the landing of the UFO, the UFO appearing as a disc, and the UFO making a sound. That is, in each set, if one of the items occurs, there is a greater-than-chance likelihood that one or more of the others in that set will occur. While Rodeghier correctly resorts to formal statistical tests, the effect in some cases is so striking that simple inspection of the tables shows the effect clearly.

RODEGHIER POINTS OUT THE OBVIOUS INFERENCE THAT IF UFOs CAUSE THESE OBVIOUSLY PHYSICAL EFFECTS THEY MUST THEMSELVES BE PHYSICAL ENTITIES.

To argue otherwise would seem untenable. Yet, one of the effects that is statistically connected with the others is 'control of the vehicle.' By this is meant that it sometimes happens that when a UFO is reported to have chased the witnesses' car, the car also comes under the control of the UFO (in addition to the likelihood that the color blue is involved and that the witnesses suffer some physiological effects) and no longer responds to the commands of the driver. It may float off the road and onto a field, or continue down the highway at break-neck speeds even with the driver's foot completely off the accelerator.

Now this latter is worse than grade B science fiction; it is unbelievably weird and totally beyond

our understanding as a connected, causative set of physical events. Other non-physical aspects, or characteristics not amenable to physical understanding, are the bodily lifting of a car and depositing it feet or yards away (yes, such events have been reported, and from various countries) and another, the almost instantaneous disappearance of the UFO. Physical objects do not just vanish, or leave instantly. (The distinction is made thusly: 'disappear' means just that, vanish like a light going out; 'leave instantly' means the exiting of the UFO in seconds, thus demanding excessively high g forces if the UFO is 'nuts-and-bolts' physical.)

Another puzzling 'non-physical' aspect not only of EM cases but of UFOs in general is the 'where are they now' question. We always can know where an actual physical craft like an airplane or a Greyhound bus is. But where is the seemingly solid, physical UFO today that stopped a car last night? Where indeed? It is not seen by residents of towns lying along its presumed getaway path, or by the sophisticated radar and infrared surveillance equipment that patrols our entire country. For all practical purposes it has disappeared from the physical scene. And yet, the EM effects have obviously been physical. How can something which does not behave like a traditional, everyday physical object produce very definite physical effects? The only way out is to declare all reported EM cases as hoaxes or coincidences. How then the many interesting statistical correlations that are shown to be beyond coincidence?

Rodeghier found thirty-five separate statistically significant correlations as against some two hundred separate non-significant correlations, which were, of course, dropped from further discussion.

Cars

As one reads this excellent survey of UFO-EM cases, one frequently pauses (at least I do!) to ask; "Can this really be 'real'? Do UFOs really appear and stop cars, or do people just think they do? We have, after all, only the witnesses' word for the event. But, in 50% of the cases we have multiple witnesses, and they all agree as to what happened, and in several very significant instances we have *independent* witnesses, as when several cars, whose drivers did not know each other, were affected. Furthermore, in earlier years, most drivers did not even know the term UFO or that such things existed and stopped cars. They did not know what to expect. Yet from many countries around the world car failures in the presence of a totally unfamiliar luminous object were reported. Very little chance of collusion here.

Even more to the point, and bearing on the reality of the phenomenon, is the disappearance of the car failure immediately upon the departure of the UFO. Many cars become totally disabled on the road — so that absolutely nothing works — but rarely do they become operative a few minutes later. Usually they must wait, hood up, for the tow truck. But how many cars become totally disabled at the precise time that a UFO appears and then also miraculously 'heal themselves' when it leaves? What is the probability that a car that has been in excellent operative condition for months becomes inoperative just exactly when a UFO appears...that would be amazing enough...but to also become operative immediately after the UFO departs? Amazement compounds amazement.

The primary contribution of Rodeghier's study should be two-fold: first to make available to serious ufologists very cogent re-

search data and second to call the attention of the scientifically curious to the existence of a real but very weird and mysterious phenomenon, amply documented, which demands acceptance and eventual explanation...an explanation which may be beyond present day science. As for acceptance, this ought not be difficult in the presence of a wealth of data, save for the propensity of the human mind, scientist and layman alike, to resist with great tenacity any new phenomenon which does not fit in with their present understanding of the world around them. The history of science is replete with many striking illustrations. But in the long run, as history shows, the resistance eventually weakens with time and the addition of evidence. Perhaps it may also be the case with UFOs and the EM cases, in particular.

We began this article with two examples of EM cases taken from the Rodeghier catalogue. It might be fitting to end with a very recent report of a typical EM case, but one which has a peculiar twist to it:

"We are writing to you to tell you about an unexplainable experience we had on July 31, 1981. My husband and I were on our way home from town, and were on an old bumpy road (near Kinston, N.C.) when our lights went out. All of them, headlights and dash lights. The engine stopped at that same time. We coasted to a stop quickly. Byron tried the headlights, the wipers, and the horn. Nothing worked. I opened the dash box to see if the flashlight was there (it wasn't) and the light in there did not come on!

"The car was in the middle of the road and my main concern was that another car would come around the curve and hit us. My husband said we had to push it off the road. I walked behind the car first (the overhead lights didn't come on when I opened the door) and he got out and we were just about to push when, poof, *all* the lights came back on. Neither of us were touching the car at that moment. Needless to say we were more amazed at this than when they went out. It was a sight, with two doors open, the dash box open, and the headlights and all the others on!

"We jumped back in and he started it up. It dragged because all the lights were on, but it started. I checked my wristwatch: it was 9:15 P.M. We drove the other one and a half miles to our home without a problem. We were shocked and excited and agitated about what had happened, and wondered what could have caused it. No cars had come either way while we were stopped.

"There were low clouds that evening. We hadn't heard or seen anything unusual. But we did think it was strange that we had been able to see as well in the total darkness as we did. It was really cloudy and there was no moon (Ed note: It was the night of the new moon). When we got home we walked out on the porch and you could hardly see your hand in front of your face, it was so dark. So I don't understand how we could see so clearly when all the lights were out...the road, car, trees, the white lines on the road.

(Continued on Page 10, Col. 3)

FROM THE HEART OF ASIA...

TWO UFOs — A HALF CENTURY APART

Imagine sighting a strange object high overhead while straining at belaying ropes...struggling to master a 24,000 foot summit in the Himalayas! It would be hard to beat that as a unique site for encountering a UFO.

Ordinarily, the sighting of UFOs occurs while the witnesses are engaged in mundane, unexciting and routine matters: walking their dogs, carrying out the garbage, driving their cars or just loafing. But Reinhold Messner, the world-famous mountain climber, and his mountaineering companion Douglas Scott, were hardly loafing when they sighted a 'Daylight Disc.' According to the reports*, Messner stated that in all his years of mountaineering he had "never seen anything like it." At first they thought it was the moon in the daylight sky, the object looking somewhat like a "transparent apple" of about the apparent size of the moon, but they soon gave up that idea when it moved in a completely un-moonlike manner ... going slowly eastward, then north-west, then north, disappearing somewhere over Tibet...moving sometimes very slowly but quickly at other times.

What then about a balloon as the answer? We don't have sufficient data to rule this out completely...a detailed plot of its trajectory, including angular rates of motion and the angular arcs of the sky covered during its excursions... but it seems very unlikely. With the object being presumably thousands of feet higher than their already considerable height, one would expect a balloon to maintain a uniform course if flying before the wind. At those heights the wind is not capricious but maintains a steady prevailing course. Messner, however, described the object's motion as

having no clear direction: "It would move quickly in one direction and then stop for ten minutes; then it would go in another direction and stop again," he told a reporter.

In the midst of a precarious mountain climbing situation one cannot expect photographs, or to have details carefully noted; observers in far more comfortable and secure locations often fail to provide such information. My feeling is that we must vote against the balloon hypothesis.

MORE THAN A HALF-CENTURY before this sighting another Himalayan UFO was reported, by another expedition. I came across this intriguing account in HEART OF ASIA (p. 149) by the explorer Nicholas Roerich, a book published in the late '20s:

"A sunny, unclouded morning ... the blue sky is brilliant. Over our camp flies a huge, dark vulture. Our Mongols and we watch it. Suddenly one of the Buriat lamas points into the blue sky: 'What is that? A white balloon? An aeroplane?'"

"We notice something shiny, flying very high, from the northeast to the south. We bring three powerful field glasses from the tents and watch the huge spheroid body shining against the sun, clearly visible against the blue sky and moving very fast., Afterwards we see that it sharply changes its direction from south to southwest and disappears behind the snow-peaked Humboldt chain. The whole camp follows the unusual apparition and the lamas whisper: "The Sign of the Shambala!"

In the late 20's the terms UFO or Daylight Disk were of course unknown, so a religious interpretation was made in this case; a half-century later Messner and his companions joked that maybe some people from outer space were coming here to learn how to climb mountains! In the year 2050 I wonder how such a sighting will be regarded!

*We have two reports on this event, one stating that it occurred on Sept. 26, 1981 and the other, on Oct. 12, 1981. Perhaps the first refers to the date of the actual sighting and the second to the date the report was made on the return of the climbers to their base at Katmandu, at which time they learned that another mountain climbing party had also sighted their object (presumably the same) a few hours earlier. □

Cars

"We have asked a few mechanics what could kill all electrical functions in a car and kill the engine. We get the same answer: they don't know of anything that could do it all. No one has any idea how it all could die and then come back to good working order the way it did. We discussed it over and over. We are fairly intelligent people and we cannot figure out any good, practical reason why our car behaved the way it did. If you can, please tell me.

"Finally, over a period of time, we accepted the idea that it had to be contact with a UFO *because there is no other explanation*" (italics mine)."

"Well, there's the twist. It had to be a UFO because there is no other explanation! What a good example of how the concept of UFOs and their actions have become a part of our background knowledge and lore. Maybe this is what it's all about. □

FOREIGN FORUM

"THE HIDE-AND-SEEK OF THE UFOs AND THE SIX JETS THAT WENT AFTER THEM"

The above was a headline in the Nov. 13, 1981 edition of the conservative and respected Greek newspaper *Mesimvri* of northern Greece. Another conservative newspaper, *Vradini*, also in Macedonia, echoed the story and added to the general account. Apparently these UFOs had scads of witnesses and were observed from the ground, from the air, and by radar. Here are the edited translations, for which we are indebted to one of the CUFOS volunteers, Mr. J. Margaritis, a graduate student at Northwestern University.

First the article from *Mesimvri*:

"Thessaloniki 13. The air controllers of the Greek-American (NATO) base in Hortiati (Macedonia) who were using radars were completely baffled yesterday at 6 o'clock in the evening when they saw UFOs on their screens. The existence of these objects was immediately confirmed by the Base. Six pursuit planes took off right away. [Ed Note: Apparently they are more on the ball than we are.] At the same time, official vehicles started searching the near-by area trying to locate the strange objects. The results of the search were negative. The UFOs disappeared as soon as the planes came close to them."

Many readers will recognize this familiar pattern. How often in the past have we heard, especially from military pilots, how UFOs outsmarted approaching aircraft.

"At 18:45, however, these UFOs appeared once again over the city of Edessa, emitting powerful lights. They looked like parachutes made out of flames. [Ed note: There is no reason to conclude that these were necessarily the same as those chased by the jets.] This event lasted for half an hour. Most citizens of the city and the area went out on streets trying to see the objects, some with binoculars.

"The inhabitants of the villages of Kalokorio, Mihaniona, Laina and of the cities of Gianitsa and Edessa were very upset by the UFO appearances and kept on calling the local police stations. According to the witnesses there were four or five UFOs which were emitting strong lights with many different colors. Their shape was constantly changing from triangles to polygons.

"At the same time the offices of *Mesimvri* in Thessaloniki were receiving numerous calls from readers who were reporting all kinds of UFO appearances. Most of them said that the objects were red and looked like small pears.

UFO reports from foreign parts obviously cannot be given the investigative attention possible for domestic reports. Careful attention, however, is given to the nature of the source of the report; only those reports which appear, in our judgment, to be reliable are used.

"From the city of Larisa, all the way up to the town of Ptolemais, people were talking about the UFOs. Some villagers argued that it could be a Turkish or a Russian, or even an American trick. One gentleman from Skidra said, 'It was something fantastic, unbelievable...I was staring at them for about ten minutes. I even took my young daughter to the window to see them. She was so happy she started clapping her hands. They were like Christmas jewels! They were almost spherical and shone like genuine pure red wine (!)."

If the newspaper account is trustworthy, this must have been quite a display, calling forth joy rather than fear and suggesting images of Christmas jewels and genuine red wine! What a pity that someone didn't get a movie of this event. In another town, however, fear seemed to be the result:

"Mrs. D.S., who lives in a suburb of Ptolemais, stated, 'I felt a strange kind of heat coming in the open window, as if it was going to strangle me. I looked to my right and I saw that huge pear! I got scared and started to scream.' Asked for further details, she replied that what struck her the most was the shape and size of the 'pear.' She was very upset and could only add that the UFO was about 500 meters away from the house and about 100 meters above the ground."

The rather lengthy news article ends with a statement from the Police Headquarters in Thessaloniki ordering all police cars to try to locate and track down the UFOs. For two hours the several police cars reported identical sightings but no UFOs were tracked down, identified or captured!

Foreign Forum

Abstracting briefly two articles from the newspaper *Vradini*, from Thessaloniki it was reported that "more strange objects appeared over Northern Greece. The inhabitants there stare at the UFOs instead of at the stars." It further reported that "The principal Police Officer of Central Macedonia, Mr. Roustis, was one of the witnesses to the main event which lasted some ten minutes" and notes that radars on the mountain Horiati picked up the objects and that for the second day air force planes scrambled after the objects, but with no luck.

As is almost always the case, we get the pontification of the local scientific expert, in this case the head of the planetarium, who opined that "the weather conditions that exist this time of year could have caused the phenomena." What weather conditions, and just how does he propose that weather conditions produce 'Christmas jewels red wine in color?'

The planetarium director is Mr. Simopoulos, and he went on to add, "Personally, I do not believe in UFOs. [Ed. note: Just what is it that he doesn't believe in? Surely all these people saw *something* which elicited both joy and fear.] However, I do not neglect the fact that there are many well-known scientists who perform research on this subject. For example, Dr. Hynek, who has founded a special UFO Center, has studied the UFO appearances without any outstanding results." (Thanks for the plug for the Center, Mr. Simopoulos, but really, nothing short of removing the 'U' from 'UFO' would probably be regarded as outstanding. But we shall try!)

Summing up: In several cities and towns of northern Greece many people saw something in the skies

When Is A Witness Not A Witness?

"About twenty days ago I was put in jail" and "P.S. I am not a good speller." Are these two good reasons for not taking this man's UFO report seriously? There are some who would certainly say so, especially if they saw the original letter sent to the Center. The statement about not being a good 'speller' is a gross understatement; 'illiterate' better describes the situation, for his disregard of the King's English is so gross as to be delightful.

And yet, he describes a strange event that he says he and his companion experienced in May 1980 but apparently kept quiet about until he had ample time on his hands in jail to report. I feel his account should be passed on to our readers; after all, reports from illiterate jailbirds are also a part of the total UFO phenomenon! (I have taken the liberty of correcting the grammar and spelling...sorry!)

It appears that Sam and Tom were joggers. "About 11 P.M. we decided to jog. We were running along the railroad tracks." Suddenly, they see a red glow about a quarter mile down the tracks and proceed to within fifty feet of the glow. "It was a ball about the same size as a basketball and it was floating about 2 or 3 feet in the air." Sam described its motion among some trees alongside the tracks and its bright glow in a composite red, yellow and orange color. "Tom pekt a rock up to het it weht, and I stop him." (Unedited sentence from the letter).

which to them was unexplainable; pursuing aircraft failed to get 'outstanding results' and the police squad cars went empty-handed, also. If the Center receives any further word on this Grecian miniflap, our readers will know about it.

"Tom pekt a rock up to het it weht, and I stop him."

"It was like it knew Tom had a rock, and then I felt a sick feeling up my back and mind, and Tom felt it too. My mind went blank and when we woke up we were 75 feet from the trees and I know I didn't walk there! I looked beside me and there was Tom. We were scared."

They went home "to think about it." The next day they revisited the scene of the encounter and found that the little trees around the tracks were brown and dead. That evening Tom called Sam on the phone: "Sam, I'm sunburned bad on my arms and face." Sam looked at his arms and they were also burned and red, he stated in his account.

Do we take this story seriously? Well, it would be very difficult to pursue a serious investigation in the face of severe communication difficulties. But why would a man for whom writing is an obvious hurdle seek out the Center with a tale of this sort? Sam's account is not greatly different from many other UFO reports and if there is substance to those, there may well be to Sam's as well. So, like many other reports which for one reason or another (in general, for lack of time and money) could not be properly followed up in a professional manner, Sam's story becomes a small part of the mighty mountain of background data on the UFO phenomenon which has come to us from many lands and many cultures. □

The Investigator's Dilemma

TYPE: CE-1
DATE: August 10, 1981
TIME: 3 A.M.
DURATION: 4 ½ (EST)
WITNESSES: 1 + (1+)
PLACE: Apple Valley, MN.

[Ed. Note: Here is a text-book example of the dilemma an investigator of UFO reports finds himself in all too often. It contains much that is instructive for it demonstrates the ever present need for critical caution in UFO investigations, and for an open (but not empty) mind. For these reasons we include this case. We should like to entertain comments from readers on this case... or on any of the others in this issue. Undoubtedly many of you would point out in this case that what was needed was a check with the local airport (too late), a series of character references and psychological tests of the witnesses (no time or funds!). Wouldn't it be nice if we had the funds of the FBI for our investigations!]

"Remember, in the movie, 'Close Encounters of the Third Kind,' when the big object first came over the mountain...before it landed?" Russell Matson told me over the phone. "Well, that's what it reminded me of when it came right over my car."

It was 3 A.M. and Matson had started on his regular early morning trip to work (at the Northstar Concrete Co.) having stopped only to pick up a pack of cigarettes. When just under two miles from his destination he saw a light ahead of him and to the left, about 15 degrees above the horizon, thinking "That's an awfully bright star!" He continued for another mile as the light came slowly closer; he now escalated his hypothesis to "probably a helicopter," as it lowered itself over a cornfield. It was now about 1000 feet away, some 500 feet away from the road and about 150 feet up in the air, Matson estimates.

He stopped his car, turned off the motor, ran his window down and turned off his radio better to listen for any noise from the object. He heard nothing. As he put his head out of the window to listen, the helicopter hypothesis was rapidly going out the window, too. Matson had been a helicopter mechanic in the army!

When he stopped his car, the object also stopped, and pivoted (Matson was emphatic about this...it pivoted, making a right-angle turn while stationary and not tipping or banking, which he said a helicopter would have to do) and now came directly toward, and over, his car. It moved slowly, only about 10 miles an hour.

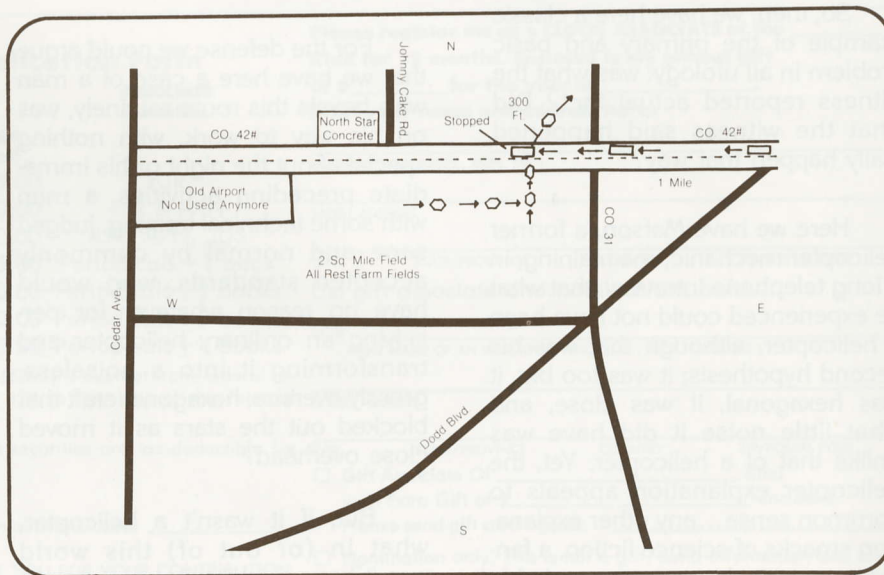
At this point, a semi (truck) pulled up behind Matson. "I pointed up and he looked up, got out of the truck onto his running board and looked directly up at the object." At this point, instead of talking to the driver, getting his name and address (which, of course, every good witness would do!) "I became scared and jumped into the car and sped off to work!" (¾ mile). He wanted to get someone else to see the object. It was moving slowly enough for this to be possible. As Matson pulled up

to the Concrete Co., his boss was just arriving and, according to Matson, he confirmed the object, in the distance. Matson did not call the police, fearing ridicule, but he did call radio station WCCO in Minneapolis, which immediately put him on the air.

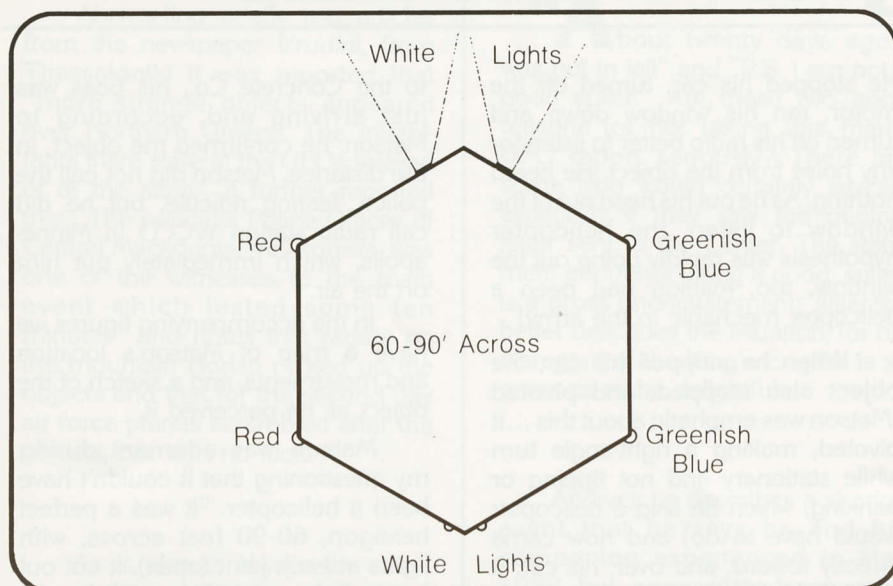
In the accompanying figures we have a map of Matson's location and movements, and a sketch of the object as he perceived it.

Matson was adamant during my questioning that it couldn't have been a helicopter. "It was a perfect hexagon, 60-90 feet across, with lights at each joint (apex). It cut out a very large part of the sky. I really got shaken."

This case is indeed a good one for study; it has its ample share of pros and cons. As so often happens, the report was made much too late to ascertain whether there was a helicopter there at the time. That would clinched things, one way or the other. The object actually didn't do anything that a helicopter couldn't do, although Matson contests this (the "perfect pivot without tipping"), but it was unlike a helicopter in that it had two sets of red and green lights, it was hexagonal,



The Investigator's Dilemma



was much larger than helicopters are, blocking out a sizeable portion of the sky as it moved along, and, until it passed directly over him (Matson maintains less than 150 feet above him), he could hear no noise. As it passed over, however, he heard a soft "whoosh," like gas escaping from a propane tank.

The truck driver has not been located and Matson's boss viewed it from too great a distance. To him it looked as though it might have been a helicopter.

So, then, we have here a classic example of the primary and basic problem in all ufology: was what the witness reported actual fact? Did what the witness said happened really happen that way?

Here we have Matson, a former helicopter mechanic, maintaining, in a long telephone interview, that what he experienced could not have been a helicopter, although that was his second hypothesis; it was too big, it was hexagonal, it was close, and what little noise it did have was unlike that of a helicopter. Yet, the helicopter explanation appeals to common sense...any other explanation smacks of science fiction, a fantastic secret device, a remarkable

hallucination, or...a UFO! (Of course, it *was* a UFO...it was unidentified!)

Certainly, this case wouldn't be one to take to the National Academy of Sciences or to NASA as proof of true UFOs! It lacks the basic criterion for a "good" case: independent witnesses. What a different situation we would have if the truck driver...or two or more other witnesses, unknown to each other, could be interrogated separately and their accounts intercompared!

For the defense we could argue that we have here a case of a man who travels this route routinely, was on his way to work, with nothing special about the night or his immediate preceding activities, a man with some technical training, judged sane and normal by commonly accepted standards, who would have no reason whatever for perceiving an ordinary helicopter and transforming it into a noiseless, grossly oversize, hexagonal craft that blocked out the stars as it moved close overhead?

But, if it wasn't a helicopter, what in (or out of) this world was it? □

BOOK REVIEW

PROJECT IDENTIFICATION:
The First Scientific Field Study
of UFO Phenomena
Harley D. Rutledge,
Prentice-Hall, 1981
265 pages

One often hears of a "long-awaited" book or report, and this is actually the case with Harley Rutledge's report of his teams' field investigation into UFO sightings in southeast Missouri. The serious student has been quite curious as to its results; owing to Dr. Rutledge's reluctance to publicize his group's efforts there have been many rumors circulating as to what those results might be. Alas, in many respects, the anticipation that here at last we had solid hard data has not been justified: Dr. Rutledge has produced a curious book which is more sizzle than steak.

Rutledge entitled his work PROJECT INVESTIGATION: The First Scientific Field Study of UFO Phenomenon. It cannot be denied that the second half of the title is in large measure true. [Ed Note: On a smaller scale there have been, in this and other countries, investigations in the field that could be characterized as scientific.] With various cameras, special film, binoculars and telescopes, and a spectrum analyzer, Rutledge's group was well-equipped to investigate the UFO mystery. One must admire their dedication and energy, as night after night was spent in the field, mainly during the years 1973 and 1974. The project team took 32 photographs of possible UFOs, most under known conditions. Such a number far surpasses any previous efforts. (Ed. Note: Mr. Dave Akers obtained nearly a dozen 'nocturnal light' photographs in the Yakima Indian Reservation when camped out in the field.) They even managed to triangulate the position and velocity (about 325 mph) of at least one UFO.

So why does the book remain unsatisfactory, in this reviewer's opinion? First, let's dispose of the small but important matter of style in which the book was written. Presumably the book was intended to be a scientific description of the project's investigations, data, and conclusions, not, I imagine, a running summary of the daily routine of Dr. Rutledge and other team members. We are apprised of the type of motel room they rented, when lunch was eaten, and which car had a flat tire, among other irrelevant details. A serious book simply doesn't require such padding, nor certainly does it make it read better. [Ed. Note: When I read the book I used the marginal notation 'w.c.' for such irrelevancies. It stands for 'who cares?'; the margins were richly annotated throughout with w.cs.]

Still, there are more serious errors, including those of fact, which did creep into the text. For example, Rutledge quotes a speed of 36,000 mph for one UFO, and states that the speed is greater than that of the fastest meteors. Such is not the case, as meteors can exhibit speeds almost three times that figure. Rutledge also seems not cognizant of the total research that has been done on the UFO phenomenon. When discussing the "success ratio"

for the project sightings, which peaked on Thursday, he notes its disagreement with other studies, which found Tuesday or Wednesday to be the peak nights. This assertion is unreferenced, but one can assume that he refers to John Keel's data, given in his book *The Mothman Prophecies*. Yet Dr. Saunders, using UFOCAT data, conclusively showed that no midweek peak exists for any category of sightings.¹ Other such errors exist; these do not affect the main conclusions of this study but do reflect on the author's knowledge of the field. □

BOOK REVIEW

All of the above, however, pale before a more serious matter which strikes at the scientific value of the study. To get to the heart of my criticism, regarding a matter which cannot be avoided in any serious attempt to come to grips with Dr. Rutledge's work, consider this statement: "Almost as astonishing as the 34 Class A sightings is the large number of sightings I have had from my yard—37." At least he realizes that this is rather astonishing, though I hardly believe that the word conveys the feeling of disbelief one

gets upon reading this statement. Given that UFOs did, and do, appear in great numbers in south-eastern Missouri, a total of 37 sightings, even of the low-significance nocturnal light variety, is unbelievable! For example, an associate of CUFOs who is both an amateur astronomer and knowledgeable about UFOs, has scanned the sky during his many years of observations and has *never* seen even one UFO. That doesn't mean that no one sees UFOs, but rather that some explanation should be sought for anyone who reports sighting a great many UFOs.

A key to an explanation of the many sightings of Rutledge and his team is this direct quote: "Although many persons have described UFOs as starlike, few, if any, were aware that UFOs would hover in the distance flashing red, white, and green (the primary colors) *in sequence*, mixing relative amounts of each color to produce a scintillating star of the desired color and brightness to the naked eye." Applying Occam's Razor, the more probable explanation for such UFOs is that they *are* scintillating stars or planets (planets do scintillate when very close to the horizon), and not UFOs masquerading as starlike objects. (Ed Note: Stars and planets alike, when close to the horizon, exhibit

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the Montigny Effect, a pronounced scintillation in various colors, generally in sequence, caused by the differing optical paths pursued by the separate spectral colors through the atmosphere.)

The huge number of sightings by project members is not consonant with any previously determined statistical distribution of UFO sightings among active observers, most of whom may see one or two UFOs during their whole lifetime.² Rutledge and two others, on Dec. 29, 1973, saw three nocturnal lights in one night! One has to wonder why Rutledge and his group were accorded a cosmic "most-favored observer" status by the UFOs.

There is no doubt that some of the sightings that the team made were unusual and could be classified as UFOs. There are some interesting photographs in the book which are not easily explained. It is quite a leap, however, from this evidence to the assertion that "an obvious intelligence had directed their (the UFOs) flight!"; made soon after the project had just begun. From the context of the writing, it is clear that the possibility that the 'obvious intelligence' might be human pilots was not entertained. Or this statement: "I now gave little credence to the theory that UFOs were a natural phenomenon." On the basis of evidence hardly more conclusive than that already avail-

able in the literature, Rutledge concluded early on that UFOs were intelligently controlled and responded to the presence of the observers. He gives little credence to other theories and bases almost his whole case on the remarkable series of "coincidences" surrounding many of the sightings. To an unbiased reviewer, however, these instances are unconvincing. They include pointing at a light which then changes direction or begins to move, and watching an approaching light move around the observer's position. One needs stronger evidence than this to prove that these are not coincidences, and even stronger evidence to establish the intelligent nature of the UFO phenomenon.

BOOK REVIEW

Another serious problem with the book is the lack of any discussion of Persinger's work on the generation of piezoelectric fields by tectonic stresses which then, according to the theory, become visible as bright moving lights. Persinger's theory applies directly to southeastern Missouri because of its high level of tectonic activity; in fact, there were earth tremors reported on May 25, 1973 during the height of the UFO wave. Many of Rutledge's sightings are similar to what Persinger's theory predicts, it seems to this

reviewer. At the very least, the existence of this theory is ample reason not to jump to unsubstantiated conclusions about the nature of the UFO phenomenon.

There are even other possible explanations for the project's large number of sightings, perhaps even deliberate hoaxing. It was no secret during the Project's existence that its members were nightly searching the sky for UFOs. The temptation to hoax is obvious and Rutledge seems unaware of this possibility.

While this book cannot be recommended for the general reader, it can be of interest to the specialist for, when all is said and done, the very existence of this book is in itself a part of the total UFO phenomenon!

Book Review by Mark Rodeghier

¹"Some New Lines for UFO Research, David R. Saunders in *MUFON '72 Conference Proceedings*, (pp. 130-142).

²"A Preliminary Report on a Survey of UFO Sightings by Amateur Astronomers" Gert Herb, in *CUFOS Bulletin*, Spring, 1978 (pp. 6-8).

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